



CELLPHONES

The P800 is the first Symbian OS v7.0 tri-band handset, with a 12-bit colour display, a small keypad, 5-way jog dial and a touch screen with a stylus. It comes with the fast ARM 9 processor. There's an audio and video player that lets you watch MP4 video and play MP3s, although video playback is sluggish.

Small features such as images with contacts, and daily, weekly and monthly views for the calendar will be appreciated, but just three types of events—appointments, reminders or all-day events—won't. There are a few good applications such as the Jotter, which allows taking down notes, MS Word and MS Excel Viewer. Included are SMS, e-mail and MMS functionality. The P800 comes with 12 MB of internal memory and a 16 MB memory stick duo card.

The P800 supports Infrared and Bluetooth, and ships with a USB cradle for recharging and syncing purposes. The most interesting feature is the inclusion of a radio-free or flight mode to ensure compatibility with sensitive devices such as hospital equipment. The lithium poly-

Sony Ericsson P800

+ Rock solid and stable Symbian 7.0 operating system, expandable memory, PDA functionality is excellent

– Plastic stylus does not provide good grip, build quality is not up to the mark, small plastic buttons on the keypad are no pleasure to work with, proprietary memory sticks, aesthetically unappealing

Price: Rs 35,400

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Reviewed In: May 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Sony Ericsson T68i

2001: NA

mer 1000 mAH battery gives 3 to 4 days of normal usage. We recommend the P800 only for a business class user, who

WORTHY MENTIONS

Nokia 3650

+ Tri-band, quality digital camera, support for external memory, support for viewing XHTML sites, slightly higher battery life than the Nokia 7650

– Odd keypad layout, poor integration of SIM, no support for cable connectivity

Price: Rs 23,999

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Reviewed In: May 2003

Sony Ericsson T68i

+ Good features, good performance, terrific price, aesthetically appealing

– Six hours of talk time is good but not enough

Price: Rs 13,000

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Reviewed In: May 2003

will actually make use of the plethora of options offered.

CPUs (PROCESSORS)

The Pentium 4 3.2 GHz runs on a 200 MHz Quad-Pumped FSB, giving it a total bandwidth of 800 MHz. It supports hyperthreading and has an easy-to-install cooling fan. We tested it on an Intel D875PBZ motherboard with support for 800 MHz FSB, 512 MB of DDR 333 MHz Kingmax RAM in dual-channel mode, with an MSI GeForce4 Ti 4800 SE graphics accelerator.

In the Quake III Arena test, the 3.2 GHz was able to pump 387 fps in normal mode, 377 fps in high quality mode and 292 fps at a resolution of 1,024 x 768 and 32-bit colour depth.

The 3DMark 2003 benchmark saw it return 700 CPU marks—the highest we've ever come across. In the SiSoft Sandra 2003 Pro's CPU arithmetic tests, it gave 9,649 Dhrystones and 6,059 Whetstones, and yielded similar results with CPU multimedia tests. The Integer benchmarks saw a score of 14,693, and FPU SSE2 yielded a huge 23,321.

The advantage of the dual channel was reflected in the the memory bandwidth

Pentium 4 3.2 GHz

+ 800 MHz FSB support, best performer till date

– None

Price: Rs 37,500

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Reviewed in: August 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: AMD Athlon 2600+

2001: Intel Pentium 4.2GHz

test—scores were 4,000 and above. The video encoding process was completed in just 70 seconds. However, the CPU took 29 minutes for the rendering in the PovRay 3.5 test.

At a price tag of Rs 37,500, you could choose to ignore the 200 MHz increase

WORTHY MENTIONS

Pentium 4 3.06 GHz

+ Northwood core, 512 KB of L2 cache, hyper-threading

– 8 KB L1 cache

Price: Rs 38,600

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Reviewed in: February 2003

AMD 1800+

+ 256 KB L2 cache, 266 MHz bus speed

– 0.18 micron fabrication

Price: Rs 3,800

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Reviewed in: February 2003

and wait for something better. But for those who need the best and need it now, this is the best money can buy.